

SENATE No. 1212

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Michael O. Moore

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to enhance courthouse security.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Michael O. Moore

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

Second Worcester

SENATE No. 1212

By Mr. Moore, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 1212) of Michael O. Moore for legislation to enhance courthouse security. The Judiciary.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 1071 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to enhance courthouse security.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 221 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby
2 amended by striking Section 70A and replacing it with the following language:-

3 “Section 70A. Court officers and those authorized to act as court officers within the
4 judicial branch may perform police duties and have police powers in or about the areas of the
5 court to which they have been assigned or on the grounds adjacent to the court, including court
6 parking lots, when so designated by the chief justice of the trial court, the chief justice of the
7 supreme judicial court or the chief justice of the appeals court as appropriate. Said court officers
8 and those authorized to act as court officer shall also have police powers when attending a court
9 proceeding convened in a location other than the courthouse, when escorting jurors on court

10 business, when escorting a judicial officer, or when participating in the care, custody or transport
11 of detainees.”